

HOUSE No. 3577**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

Andres X. Vargas and Manny Cruz*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing a zero carbon renovation fund.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Andres X. Vargas</i>	<i>3rd Essex</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>Manny Cruz</i>	<i>7th Essex</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>Paul McMurtry</i>	<i>11th Norfolk</i>	<i>1/24/2025</i>
<i>Lindsay N. Sabadosa</i>	<i>1st Hampshire</i>	<i>1/31/2025</i>
<i>Christopher Richard Flanagan</i>	<i>1st Barnstable</i>	<i>2/3/2025</i>
<i>Steven Owens</i>	<i>29th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/6/2025</i>
<i>Erika Uytterhoeven</i>	<i>27th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/6/2025</i>
<i>James K. Hawkins</i>	<i>2nd Bristol</i>	<i>2/12/2025</i>
<i>Jacob R. Oliveira</i>	<i>Hampden, Hampshire and Worcester</i>	<i>2/12/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>2/12/2025</i>
<i>Samantha Montaño</i>	<i>15th Suffolk</i>	<i>2/12/2025</i>
<i>Jason M. Lewis</i>	<i>Fifth Middlesex</i>	<i>2/20/2025</i>
<i>Mindy Domb</i>	<i>3rd Hampshire</i>	<i>2/24/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>2/24/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>3/3/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/11/2025</i>
<i>Adrianne Pusateri Ramos</i>	<i>14th Essex</i>	<i>3/11/2025</i>
<i>Christopher J. Worrell</i>	<i>5th Suffolk</i>	<i>3/11/2025</i>

<i>Danillo A. Sena</i>	<i>37th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/18/2025</i>
<i>Sean Garballey</i>	<i>23rd Middlesex</i>	<i>3/24/2025</i>
<i>Tara T. Hong</i>	<i>18th Middlesex</i>	<i>6/17/2025</i>
<i>Margaret R. Scarsdale</i>	<i>1st Middlesex</i>	<i>10/10/2025</i>
<i>Nick Collins</i>	<i>First Suffolk</i>	<i>1/29/2026</i>
<i>John Francis Moran</i>	<i>9th Suffolk</i>	<i>3/9/2026</i>

HOUSE No. 3577

By Representatives Vargas of Haverhill and Cruz of Salem, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 3577) of Andres X. Vargas, Manny Cruz and others for legislation to establish a zero carbon renovation fund to provide for the costs associated with energy efficiency renovations of certain existing buildings. Telecommunications, Utilities and Energy.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing a zero carbon renovation fund.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 21A of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting the
2 following section:

3 Section 29. There shall be established and set up on the books of the commonwealth a
4 fund to be known as the Zero Carbon Renovation Fund that shall be administered by the
5 Executive Office of Energy and Environmental Affairs, in consultation with the Department of
6 Energy Resources, the Massachusetts Clean Energy Technology Center, the Governor's Office
7 of Climate Innovation and Resilience, the Executive Office of Housing and Livable
8 Communities, the Massachusetts School Building Authority, the Executive Office of Economic
9 Development, the Massachusetts Housing Partnership Fund Board, and the Massachusetts
10 Development Finance Agency, who shall expend the funds for costs associated with the
11 renovation of existing buildings including Affordable housing as defined by section 38D of
12 chapter 121B, homes rented or owned by low or moderate income households as defined by

section 38D of chapter 121B, municipal buildings, including, but not limited to, public schools, and small businesses with Massachusetts State Supplier Diversity Office Certifications to conduct "Zero Carbon Renovations" so that these buildings shall, to the maximum extent practicable: (i) be highly energy efficient; (ii) use all-electric heating, hot water, and cooking technologies; (iii) include on-site renewable energy generating sources; and (iv) be renovated with low-embodied carbon materials. Funds may also be expended as necessary for costs associated with the remediation of existing building conditions which must be addressed before a Zero Carbon Renovation can be completed. Such remediations may include but not be limited to mitigation of mold, asbestos, insect and animal infestation, lead paint, electric system upgrades to meet current code or facilitate building electrification, accessibility upgrades required for compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act, and remediation of any structural issues related to accommodating the Zero Carbon Renovation. Said fund shall be available to buildings throughout the Commonwealth, while prioritizing Affordable housing and low or moderate income homes, public schools, and other buildings located in: (i) environmental justice communities, as defined in section 62 of chapter 30 and (ii) gateway cities, provided, however, that monies deposited in said fund shall, to the maximum extent feasible, be allocated and spent through existing programs supporting the aforementioned decarbonization activities. (There shall be credited to the fund all amounts that are transferred, or authorized to be transferred thereto, or directed to be deposited therein, and all amounts received as gifts, grants, or contributions for the purposes of the fund. Any money remaining in the fund at the close of a fiscal year shall not revert to the General Fund, but shall remain available for expenditure in subsequent fiscal years.

XXXX-XXXX For a reserve, as established in Section 29 of Chapter 21A of the General Laws, to support the renovation of existing buildings including affordable housing; homes of low

36 or moderate income households; municipal buildings, including, but not limited to, public
37 schools; and small businesses with Massachusetts State Supplier Diversity Office Certifications,
38 provided, however, that funds in this item shall be administered by the Executive Office of
39 Energy and Environmental Affairs, in consultation with the Department of Energy Resources,
40 the Massachusetts Clean Energy Technology Center, the Governor's Office of Climate
41 Innovation and Resilience, the Executive Office of Housing and Livable Communities, the
42 Massachusetts School Building Authority, the Executive Office of Economic Development, the
43 Massachusetts Housing Partnership Fund Board, and the Massachusetts Development Finance
44 Agency, for Zero Carbon Renovations; provided further that not less than \$300,000,000 shall be
45 transferred to the Zero Carbon Renovation Fund\$300,000,000